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EQUITY: CONSUMER RELATED

Sales of a leading high-end mall operator softened in 2Q26

However, shopping mall expert remains optimistic for 2H26

Research Analysts

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We hosted a channel check call (24 June) with an expert with deep knowledge of China's high-end consumption trend based on the expert's observations on a leading luxury shopping mall operator in China (with more than 100 mid- to high-end shopping malls, mostly located in China's tier-1 and leading tier-2/3 cities). Our key takeaways are summarised below.

Sales momentum marginally softened in 2Q26

- China's leading high-end malls, in general, witnessed a slightly softened sales momentum quarter-to-date (QTD) 2Q26, according to the expert. The expert shared that same-store sales (SSS) across projects of the leading high-end shopping mall player increased by mid-single-digit% (MSD%) y-y and total foot traffic was up by low-single-digit% (LSD%) y-y in April (decelerated from the low-teens%/high-single-digit% y-y performance for SSSG/foot traffic in March); driven by increased marketing activities in May, both SSS and foot traffic registered high-single-digit% (HSD%) y-y growth in May; however, month-to-date June, the shopping malls saw MSD% y-y growth for both SSS and foot traffic.
- Meanwhile, luxury shopping malls still outperformed non-luxury shopping malls in 2Q26, according to the expert. The expert also noted that catering and entertainment segments in luxury shopping malls enjoyed faster SSSG than other brands.
- The expert remains optimistic on the shopping malls' performance in 2H26, based on the expert's belief of a K-shaped recovery of the China consumer space; wealthy consumers should be the direct beneficiaries of China's stock market boom, and stabilising property markets in tier-1 cities such as Shanghai and Shenzhen, leading to the outperformance of luxury/high-end shopping malls' sales, according to the expert.

Performance by key segment

- Luxury brands: overall luxury brands saw decelerated SSSG performance in QTD 2Q26, compared with c.10% y-y SSSG of luxury brands in March, according to the expert.
- Gold & jewelry: the expert saw a weakened momentum of the gold & jewelry segment in 2Q26, with SSSG down by low-teens%/mid-teens% y-y in April and May. While the expert mentioned that the domestic premium jewelry brand Laopu Gold (6181 HK, Buy) continued to deliver a better-than-expected sales performance in 2Q26 across the leading luxury shopping mall player's projects, the brand's April SSSG registered c.50% y-y and SSSG accelerated to >60% y-y in May. According to the expert, Laopu has progressed steadily towards a luxury positioned-brand through strategic store adjustments and special marketing activities towards high-end luxury consumers.
- Outdoor: the expert sees the sales momentum as still resilient in the outdoor segment; luxury sportswear brands such as Arc'teryx (owned by Amer Sports [AS US, Buy]) and Salomon (owned by Amer Sports, AS US, Buy) still enjoyed >20% y-y SSSG in QTD 2Q26.

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Appendix A-1

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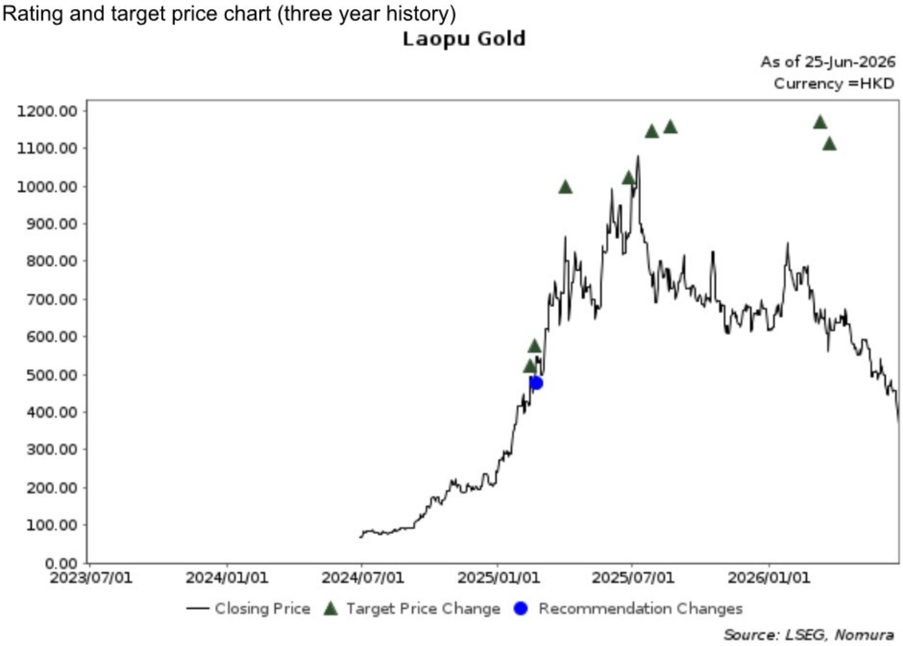
Issuer	Ticker	Price	Price date	Stock rating	Sector rating	Disclosures
Laopu Gold	6181 HK	HKD 367.80	25-Jun-2026	Buy	N/A	
Amer Sports Inc	AS US	USD 35.10	24-Jun-2026	Buy	N/A	

Laopu Gold (6181 HK) **HKD 367.80 (25-Jun-2026)** Buy (Sector rating: N/A)

Rating and target price chart (three year history)



Date	Rating	Target price	Closing price
24-Mar-26		1,114.00	648.50
11-Mar-26		1,171.00	654.00
21-Aug-25		1,160.00	751.00
27-Jul-25		1,148.00	764.50
26-Jun-25		1,023.00	868.50
02-Apr-25		999.00	799.00
20-Feb-25		576.00	468.40
14-Feb-25	Buy		493.00
14-Feb-25		525.00	493.00

For explanation of ratings refer to the stock rating keys located after chart(s)

Valuation Methodology Our target price of HKD1,114 is based on 22.5x FY26F P/E, consistent with Laopu's high sales and earnings growth trajectory. The benchmark index for the company is the Hang Seng Index.
Risks that may impede the achievement of the target price Key downside risks include: 1) any significant weakening of gold price, 2) higher-than-expected fashion risk, 3) weaker-than-expected macro environment.

Amer Sports Inc (AS US) **USD 35.10 (24-Jun-2026)** Buy (Sector rating: N/A)

Rating and target price chart (three year history)

Date	Rating	Target price	Closing price
20-May-26		49.30	34.84
25-Feb-26		47.90	37.85
19-Nov-25	Buy		34.76
19-Nov-25		39.80	34.76
21-Sep-25	Neutral		37.45
21-Sep-25		38.30	37.45
20-Aug-25		43.20	37.17
21-May-25		40.10	37.00
26-Feb-25		36.70	30.31
11-Dec-24		30.00	25.76
20-Nov-24		22.70	20.96
23-Sep-24	Buy		14.93
23-Sep-24		18.60	14.93

For explanation of ratings refer to the stock rating keys located after chart(s)

Valuation Methodology We have applied a target EV/EBITDA for each of Amer's segments and value the company based on a SOTP valuation methodology; we have set the target F12M EV/EBITDA of 15x / 19x / 14x to our adjusted EBITDA estimates for Amer's Technical Apparel / Outdoor / Ball & Racquet segments. Our target price of USD49.30 implies a 16.3x F12M EV/EBITDA. The benchmark index of Amer Sports is the NASDAQ Index.
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